



Your Only Job Is To Heal

C-Section Recovery Journal

A Gentle 6-Week Healing Plan After Surgery



Welcome Mama, You Did Something Incredible.

Bringing a child into this world is a monumental feat, and doing so through major abdominal surgery is nothing short of heroic. Your body has been through a massive transition. This journal is designed not to pressure you to "bounce back," but to hold your hand as you heal, day by day, for the next six weeks.

Important Medical Disclaimer

This journal is an educational tracking tool ONLY. It is NOT medical advice and does NOT substitute for professional medical diagnosis, treatment, or care from your OB-GYN or healthcare team. The information herein is based on general postpartum recovery guidelines from ACOG and the ERAS Society, and may not apply to your individual situation. Always consult your doctor before starting any exercises or changing any medications. Never disregard professional medical advice because of something you read in this journal. If you experience any concerning symptoms, contact your healthcare provider immediately.

“Resting is not laziness. Resting is active recovery.”



References: ACOG Committee Opinion No. 736 (2018); ERAS Society Guidelines for Postoperative Care in Cesarean Delivery (2026); CDC Hear Her Campaign (2024).

The Postpartum 5-5-5 Rule

The 5-5-5 rule is a gentle framework designed to protect your early recovery by setting firm boundaries around your physical activity during the first 15 days at home. By organizing your healing into three distinct 5-day phases, you give your deep abdominal incisions the quiet environment they need to begin stitching back together.

☀ Phase 1: 5 Days IN the Bed (Days 1–5)

Focus: Absolute rest, bonding, and initial pain management.

- ☐ Spend 90% of your day lying down or reclined in bed.
- ☐ Keep baby's bassinet next to your bed so you do not stretch or lift.
- ☐ Practice skin-to-skin bonding to stimulate oxytocin and support healing.
- ☐ Keep recovery station stocked: water, snacks, pain meds, maternity pads.
- ☐ Let your partner/family handle all meals, chores, and diaper changes.

☀ Phase 2: 5 Days ON the Bed (Days 6–10)

Focus: Sitting up, brief visits, but still no walking around the house.

- ☐ Transition to sitting upright on the bed supported by pillows.
- ☐ Read to your baby, practice gentle breathing, or spend quiet time with siblings.
- ☐ Limit visits to 15–20 minutes; keep visitors in your bedroom.
- ☐ Let others continue to bring meals directly to your bedside.
- ☐ Gently stretch your ankles and wrists to keep circulation flowing.

The Postpartum 5-5-5 Rule

continued

☀ Phase 3: 5 Days AROUND the Bed (Days 11–15)

Focus: Very short walks. Avoid stairs, lifting, or standing for long periods.

- ☐ Take slow 2-to-3 minute walks inside your room or down the hall to prevent blood clots.
- ☐ Sit in a comfortable chair in your bedroom for short periods.
- ☐ Do not go up or down stairs more than once a day if absolutely necessary.
- ☐ Do not attempt any light housework, sweeping, or cooking.
- ☐ Continue to prioritize lying down whenever you feel a dull ache in your abdomen.

Important Reminder

While rest is critical, gentle movement (even wiggling your toes in bed) helps prevent blood clots. The 5-5-5 rule is a guideline, not a rigid prescription. Listen to your body and consult your medical team.

Week 1: Protecting the Foundation

Focus: Incision protection, pain management, and deep rest.

Pain Scale (1–10):

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Medication Tracker:

Acetaminophen: ☐ Dose 1 ☐ Dose 2 ☐ Dose 3 ☐ Dose 4

NSAID (Ibuprofen): ☐ Dose 1 ☐ Dose 2 ☐ Dose 3

Other/Rx: _____ Time: _____

Incision Visual Check:

Dry & Intact? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Any redness, warmth, or oozing? ☐ Yes ☐ No (If yes, call doctor)

Lochia (Postpartum Bleeding):

☐ Lochia Rubra (Bright red, heavy to moderate — normal for Week 1)

Heavy Clots (larger than golf ball)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Physical Symptoms:

Temperature: _____°F/°C

First bowel movement passed? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Hydration: [] [] [] [] [] [] [] [] (8 glasses)

Daily Emotional Check-In:

Today my body feels:

Today my heart feels:

One thing I need help with today:



YOUR ONLY JOB IS TO HEAL

You have seen Week 1. 5 more weeks of healing are waiting for you.

This free preview gave you the foundation — the 5-5-5 Rule and your first daily tracker.

The full journal walks beside you every single day, all the way to your 6-week check-in.

The Complete 6-Week Journal Includes:

- ✦ Week 1 to 6 Daily Trackers — pain, incision, bleeding, mood
- ✦ Gentle Walking Progress Log — 30+ entry rows
- ✦ Emotional Check-In and PHQ-2 Mood Screener
- ✦ "Ask For Help" Scripts — 5 ready-to-send messages
- ✦ Pelvic Floor and Core Reconnection Guide (3 levels)
- ✦ Pain and Medication Log — date, dose, before and after
- ✦ Deep Healing Journal Prompts — 3 pages
- ✦ Urgent Warning Signs quick-reference page

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*"Resting is not laziness. Resting is active recovery."
You are exactly where you need to be, Mama.*